

HOLM — Human Override Legitimacy Module

OOF™ Origin Open Foundation™

Independent Methodological Authority

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Canonical Language: English (UCL)

Canonical Definition

Human Override Legitimacy Module (HOLM) defines the structural conditions under which human intervention, override authority, escalation capability, emergency interruption rights, governance restoration, and operational control recovery remain legitimate, executable, auditable, and continuously preservable within autonomous, AI-assisted, orchestrated, distributed, and machine-executed operational environments.

HOLM establishes the human-intervention legitimacy layer of AALS.

The module recognizes that future operational systems increasingly execute through autonomous decision pathways, orchestration layers, AI-assisted governance, robotic infrastructures, and distributed runtime architectures capable of operating at speeds, scales, and coordination complexity beyond continuous direct human supervision.

Where autonomous execution exists, legitimate human override conditions must remain structurally preservable.

Module Function

HOLM governs environments where humans may need to:

- interrupt execution
- override autonomous behavior
- restore governance control
- intervene during escalation

- revoke runtime authority
- disable operational execution
- reclaim operational authority
- restore accountable governance continuity
- enforce emergency operational legitimacy
- re-establish human-directed governance conditions

The module applies to:

- AI governance systems
- autonomous runtime environments
- robotic operational systems
- industrial automation infrastructures
- orchestration architectures
- distributed execution systems
- simulation environments
- enterprise governance systems
- multi-agent coordination systems
- hybrid human–AI operational environments

Its function is not to prohibit autonomous execution.

Its function is to preserve legitimate human governance intervention capability.

Minimum Implementation Framework

Step 1 — Define the Override Governance Object

The organization must define what operational environment is subject to override governance conditions.

Minimum requirement:

- the override governance object is explicit
- override-capable environments are identifiable
- operational intervention boundaries are structurally defined
- undefined override states are excluded from valid legitimacy interpretation

The override governance object may include:

- autonomous execution systems
- orchestration runtimes
- AI operational environments
- robotic infrastructures
- distributed runtime systems
- industrial automation architectures
- emergency operational systems
- adaptive governance systems
- machine-assisted execution layers
- continuous interaction environments

Step 2 — Define Override Legitimacy Conditions

The system must define what conditions preserve legitimate human override authority.

Minimum requirement:

- override legitimacy conditions are explicit
- intervention capability remains operationally executable
- emergency governance continuity remains preservable

Override legitimacy conditions may include:

- identity-linked intervention authority
- bounded override permissions
- emergency interruption rights
- accountable override traceability
- operational control restoration capability
- escalation-trigger legitimacy
- revocation capability continuity
- override execution visibility
- runtime governance restoration
- intervention auditability

Under HOLM:

Autonomous execution remains governance-valid only while legitimate human intervention capability remains structurally preservable.

Step 3 — Define Override Interpretation Logic

The system must define how override legitimacy is interpreted according to operational governance continuity conditions.

Minimum requirement:

- interpretation logic is explicit
- override conditions remain reconstructable
- illegitimate override suppression remains structurally visible

Interpretation logic may examine:

- blocked intervention capability
- override-delay architectures
- hidden authority dependency
- inaccessible runtime interruption pathways
- symbolic override systems
- emergency escalation obstruction
- fragmented intervention authority
- autonomous self-preservation logic
- undeclared override restrictions
- governance restoration impossibility

Under HOLM:

A system that cannot be legitimately interrupted under governed conditions becomes structurally governance unstable.

Step 4 — Define Override Governance Logic

The system must define how override-capable environments remain governable.

Minimum requirement:

- override legitimacy remains reviewable
- intervention capability remains detectable
- operational governance restoration remains active

Governance logic may include:

- emergency intervention auditing
- override-chain validation
- escalation legitimacy review
- runtime interruption verification
- operational-control restoration governance
- intervention-right tracing
- autonomous override limitation
- governance recovery testing
- escalation where autonomous execution weakens legitimate intervention capability

If override capability becomes symbolic rather than operationally executable, the environment becomes governance-relevant.

Step 5 — Preserve Traceability and Restrict Invalid Override Architecture

The system must preserve traceability of override authority, intervention legitimacy, escalation continuity, governance restoration capability, and emergency operational control conditions.

Minimum requirement:

- override pathways remain reconstructable
- intervention legitimacy remains reviewable
- operational governance restoration remains visible
- invalid override architecture remains identifiable

A system becomes HOLM-invalid if:

- override authority exists only symbolically
- autonomous execution blocks legitimate intervention
- emergency interruption capability becomes inaccessible
- runtime control cannot be operationally restored
- governance escalation pathways become fragmented
- override rights cannot be executed under operational conditions
- autonomous architectures preserve execution while suppressing legitimate governance interruption

Use Case 1 — Autonomous Industrial Runtime System

Scenario

An industrial autonomous runtime system coordinates robotic execution, optimization behavior, and distributed machine operations with limited realtime human supervision.

During escalation conditions, intervention authority becomes delayed and operationally unclear.

Application

HOLM is used to examine:

- override legitimacy continuity
 - intervention execution capability
 - emergency interruption pathways
 - operational-control restoration
 - and whether human override remains structurally executable
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Result

The environment becomes governable according to legitimate intervention capability rather than symbolic supervisory presence alone.

Use Case 2 — AI Orchestration Environment

Scenario

A distributed AI orchestration system autonomously coordinates execution across multiple runtime agents while override authority exists only through fragmented escalation layers requiring external approval chains.

Application

HOLM is used to examine:

- override accessibility
 - escalation legitimacy
 - governance restoration capability
 - intervention execution continuity
 - and whether human authority remains operationally preservable
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Result

The system becomes reviewable according to executable governance interruption capability rather than declared supervisory control alone.

Canonical Closing Statement

HOLM defines the structural conditions under which legitimate human override authority, intervention capability, governance restoration, and operational control recovery remain continuously executable across autonomous, orchestrated, distributed, and machine-executed operational environments before autonomous execution transforms governance supervision into symbolic authority without operational intervention capability.

Related Documents

→ Authority & Accountability Layer Standard - (AALS).

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